

# Debate: Critical Thinking in the Age of AI

SMaiLE Project

## Key Information

**Target Group:** 13 - 16 y.o.

**Duration:** 60 min

### Key Learning Goals:

1. **Critical Thinking:** Empower students to think ethically about AI.
2. **Research:** Develop skills to find and evaluate information.
3. **Communication:** Present arguments clearly and listen respectfully.
4. **Collaboration:** Work effectively in teams to build strategies.

## Learning Outcomes

Students will be able to:

### KNOWLEDGE & UNDERSTANDING:

- Define basic AI concepts (algorithms, chatbots).
- Identify potential benefits and risks of AI in diverse contexts.
- Explain different ethical viewpoints.

### SKILLS & ABILITIES:

- Conduct independent research using appropriate sources.
- Formulate arguments supported by evidence.
- Distinguish between facts and opinions.

### ATTITUDES & VALUES:

- Demonstrate curiosity about technology's societal impact.
- Value ethical considerations and responsible AI use.

## European Dimension / Erasmus+ Connection

- **EU Values:** Discussing democracy, human rights, and privacy (GDPR).
- **Cross-Border Collaboration:** Sharing research and debates with European partners.



- **Digital Citizenship:** Combating misinformation and promoting digital literacy.



## 1. Resources and Tools

- **Materials:** "Understanding Team Policy Debate" Infographic, Intro PPT.
- **Assessment:** Judging Rubrics, Self-Evaluation forms.
- **Tech:** Computers with Wi-Fi, Projector, Padlet for audience voting.

### Useful Links

- [School AI policy example](#)
- [Edutopia article on students using AI](#)
- [Introductory AI ethics video](#)
- [Debate starter video](#)
- [BBC article on AI hiring bias](#)
- [BBC topic page on facial recognition](#)
- [Video on AI in schools and surveillance](#)
- [Short video prompt on AI ethics](#)
- [Article on AI in social media algorithms](#)

### Classroom Support Materials

- Prepare a debate checklist, printed role cards, and a visible timer for each debate round.

## Activity Overview

| Phase   | Time   | Activity                                                                                 |
|---------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Intro   | 10 min | <b>Context:</b> Introduction via video/story. Defining roles (Affirmative/Negative).     |
| Prep    | 20 min | <b>Research:</b> Group work to find evidence and prepare speeches.                       |
| Debate  | 20 min | <b>Action:</b> Team policy debate with structured rounds (Opening, Crossfire, Rebuttal). |
| Reflect | 10 min | <b>Evaluation:</b> Scoring, audience voting (Padlet), and self-reflection.               |

## 2. Topics for Debate

### Phase 2.1: AI in Education

- **Surveillance:** "Should AI be used to monitor students in schools?" (Safety vs. Privacy).
- **Tools:** "Should schools teach students how to use AI tools like ChatGPT?"

### Phase 2.2: AI and Ethics

- **Healthcare:** "Should decisions about patient care be made by AI?"
- **Employment:** "Should AI be used to decide who gets a job?"



## Phase 2.3: AI in Everyday Life

- **Social Media:** "Should AI control what we see on social media?" (Algorithms vs. Free Choice).
- **Transport:** "Should you trust an autonomous car?"

## 3. The Debate Structure

- **Constructive Speeches:** Teams present their case (2 min).
- **Cross-Examination:** Direct questioning of opponents (3 min).
- **Rebuttal:** Refuting arguments (5 min).

## 4. Reflection and Evaluation

- **Judges:** Score based on Arguments (30%), Evidence (25%), Delivery (20%), and Rebuttals (15%).
- **Audience:** Participate via Padlet to vote for the most convincing team.
- **Self-Eval:** Students reflect on their own performance.